FAMILY DEVOTIONS FOR THE WEEK

Faith Formation for Families • The Congregation at Prayer • Week of September 13–19, 2026

Season of Pentecost ✠ Liturgical Color: Green

Invocation
In the name of the Father and of the ✠ Son and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.

Introit (see back page)

Memory Verse for the Week — Psalm 143:8
"Let me hear in the morning of Your steadfast love, for in You I trust. Make me know the way I should go, for to You I lift up my soul."

Daily Readings: LSB p. 299

Sun: 2 Chronicles 32:1–22; Colossians 1:1–23
Mon: 2 Chronicles 33:1–25; Colossians 1:24—2:7
Tue: 2 Chronicles 34:1–4, 8–11, 14–33; Colossians 2:8–23
Wed: 2 Chronicles 35:1–7, 16–25; Colossians 3:1–25
Thu: 2 Chronicles 36:1–23; Colossians 4:1–18
Fri: Nehemiah 1:1—2:10; 1 Timothy 1:1–20
Sat: Nehemiah 2:11–20; 4:1–6; 1 Timothy 2:1–15

Talk About It This Week
Each day, read the appointed readings (or just one), then ask: *Where did we hear God's Word planted today? What is God teaching us to trust?* Day-by-day questions for younger and older children are in the daily devotion pages (and on the web page).

In Our Prayers This Week (LSB Daily Prayer Themes)
✠ **Sun:** the joy of the resurrection; fruit of faith in all who heard the Word today
✠ **Mon:** our Baptism, callings, and daily work; schools; good government and peace
✠ **Tues:** deliverance from temptation and evil; the addicted and despairing
✠ **Wed:** marriage and family; parents and children; our home and community
✠ **Thurs:** the Church, pastors, teachers, and missionaries; thanksgiving for the Sacrament
✠ **Fri:** the preaching of the cross; the persecuted; the sick and the dying
✠ **Sat:** faithfulness to the end; hearts made ready for the Lord's Day

Hymn of the Week: "Our Father, Who from Heaven Above" — LSB 766
Forgive our sins, Lord, we implore, / That they may trouble us no more; / We too will gladly those forgive / Who hurt us by the way they live. / Help us in our community / To serve each other willingly.

Apostles' Creed

Lord's Prayer

Benediction
Let us bless the Lord. **Thanks be to God.**

HOW TO USE THIS PAGE… Gather once a day — at breakfast, supper, or bedtime. Speak the Invocation, say the memory verse together, read the day's readings, talk about them, sing the hymn stanza, pray for the day's theme, and close with the Lord's Prayer and Benediction. Ten minutes is plenty. The seed does the work — "so shall My word be… it shall not return to Me empty" (Isaiah 55:11).

The Sixteenth Sunday after Pentecost (Proper 19) September 13, 2026

Season of Pentecost ✠ Liturgical Color: Green

Introit *Psalm 143:1–2; antiphon: v. 9*

Deliver me from my enemies, O LORD!
I have fled to you for refuge.
Hear my prayer, O LORD; give ear to my pleas for mercy!
In your faithfulness answer me, in your righteousness!
Enter not into judgment with your servant,
for no one living is righteous before you.
Glory be to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit;
as it was in the beginning, is now, and will be forever. Amen.
Deliver me from my enemies, O LORD!
I have fled to you for refuge.

Collect of the Day

O God, our refuge and strength, the author of all godliness, hear the devout prayers of Your Church, especially in times of persecution, and grant that what we ask in faith we may obtain; through Jesus Christ, our Lord, who lives and reigns with You and the Holy Spirit, one God, now and forever. Amen.

This Sunday's Readings

Genesis 50:15–21 · Psalm 103:1–12 · Romans 14:1–12 · Matthew 18:21–35

Gradual *Psalm 34:9, 19*

Oh, fear the LORD, you his saints,
for those who fear him have no lack!
Many are the afflictions of the righteous,
but the LORD delivers him out of them all.

Next Sunday's Readings (Proper 20)

Isaiah 55:6–9 · Psalm 27:1–9 · Philippians 1:12–14, 19–30 · Matthew 20:1–16

Learn by Heart: The Fifth Petition of the Lord's Prayer *LSB p. 324*

"We pray in this petition that our Father in heaven would not look at our sins, or deny our prayer because of them. We are neither worthy of the things for which we pray, nor have we deserved them, but we ask that He would give them all to us by grace."

THIS WEEK AT HOME: Peter thinks he is being generous when he offers to forgive seven times. Jesus answers seventy-seven, and then tells of a servant forgiven a debt he could never have repaid in a hundred lifetimes — who then throttles a man over pocket change. This week the readings give the astonishing case of Manasseh, the worst king Judah ever had, who repents in a foreign prison and is forgiven. Ask one another: "What has God forgiven in us that we would be ashamed to say out loud — and who are we still holding something against?"

Kids in the Divine Service — What does "redemption" mean?

"Redemption" comes from the word "redeem," which means "to buy back." God's plan of redemption was His plan to buy us back from sin, death, and the power of the devil. Jesus kept the Law perfectly and died on the cross in our place. He paid the high price for sin and bought us back — and then rose from the dead to prove it.

This week's Gospel is about a debt. The servant owed ten thousand talents, more money than he could earn in many lifetimes, and the king simply cancelled it. That is what redemption means: not a smaller bill, but a paid one.

Parents: *What God has done for us in Jesus reflects the fatherly love He has for all people. Share that love with your children through the means the Lord has given — Word and Sacrament — where we receive the real fruits of redemption.*

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